

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with extensive hands-on experience managing, operating, and optimising enterprise security platforms, including CrowdStrike Falcon for Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) solutions, web application firewalls, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM). I have built and led a hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC) at the University of the Arts London (UAL), deployed and tuned CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, and NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user estate, and served as the senior escalation lead for complex security incidents in line with NIST 800-61. I bring proven experience in vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking, EDR and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert triage and response, firewall policy management, and contributing to ad hoc security projects. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and thrive in collaborative, operationally focused security teams where continuous improvement is a shared goal.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) — expert deployment, management, and tuning; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **SIEM and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (workspace design, KQL analytics rules, data connectors, playbooks, workbooks)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune, MDM, MAM, Tanium
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email security gateway
- **Firewall and Perimeter:** Check Point Harmony Endpoint and firewall policy management
- **Privileged Access:** BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR automation, KQL
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, playbook authoring, senior escalation lead
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK, JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Manage and optimise the CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform across an 8,000-user estate, administering Prevent, Insight, Discover, and NG-SIEM modules to maintain continuous endpoint protection and visibility
- Lead day-to-day SIEM and SOAR operations including alert monitoring, triage, investigation, and escalation of security events from across the technology estate
- Serve as the senior incident response escalation lead, managing the full lifecycle of security incidents from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, aligned to NIST 800-61
- Conduct vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera BAS, tracking remediation activities against agreed risk thresholds and reporting to senior stakeholders
- Operate and maintain Mimecast email security, Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM, and Check Point Harmony firewall, including policy review and rule optimisation
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD, including Conditional Access policy design, MFA rollout, and SSO integrations, reducing identity-based risk across the estate

- Coordinate remediation of penetration test findings, working with infrastructure and application teams to track and close vulnerabilities within agreed timescales
- Contribute to ad hoc security projects including platform upgrades, tooling evaluations, and security control improvements

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts across SIEM and EDR platforms, investigating events and escalating incidents in accordance with defined playbooks
- Supported the deployment and management of CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across the UAL estate
- Assisted in vulnerability scanning programmes using Nessus and Tenable.io, producing remediation reports for infrastructure and application teams
- Contributed to identity and access management operations including Entra ID administration, Conditional Access policy updates, and MFA enablement across the user population
- Authored and maintained security incident response playbooks and standard operating procedures to improve consistency of security operations
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM deployment, administering privileged access policies and monitoring privileged session activity
- Delivered security awareness briefings and phishing simulation campaigns to reduce end-user risk exposure

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed endpoint protection, patch management, and security tooling across the corporate IT estate in a SaaS and FinTech environment
- Administered identity and access management, including Active Directory user provisioning, access reviews, and access control policy enforcement
- Supported network and infrastructure security monitoring, investigating alerts and escalating security events to senior engineers
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities, including evidence collection, control gap analysis, and policy documentation
- Implemented and maintained MDM solutions for corporate device management and security baseline enforcement

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised UAL's hybrid SOC from the ground up, integrating CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel to deliver unified threat visibility across cloud and on-premises environments
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and EDR modules across an 8,000-user estate, achieving comprehensive endpoint protection coverage and enabling proactive threat hunting capability
- Designed and implemented BeyondTrust PAM across UAL, eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and establishing a full audit trail for all administrative sessions
- Led UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme, coordinating cross-team remediation and achieving certification within the target timescale
- Delivered an 8,000-user Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment, consolidating endpoint detection capability onto a unified Microsoft security platform
- Served as senior incident response escalation lead for major security incidents, producing post-incident reports and driving control improvements to prevent recurrence

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)